

LoadAfrica

Logistics & Plant Hire Management Platform Client Overview & Functional Documentation Version 1.0

1. Project Overview

LoadAfrica is a centralized logistics and plant hire management platform developed to simplify cargo transportation and heavy equipment hiring across South Africa. The system connects customers, brokers, fleet owners, drivers and administrators through a single digital platform, replacing manual coordination with a structured and transparent workflow.

The platform enables customers to create transport bookings and plant hire requests, while brokers manage quotations and assignments. Once approved, transport providers complete the job and customers can monitor the progress throughout the lifecycle.

2. Business Objectives

- Digitize transport and plant hire operations.
- Reduce manual coordination through phone calls and emails.
- Provide a transparent quotation process.
- Improve operational efficiency and booking visibility.
- Create a scalable platform for future expansion.

3. User Roles

Customer

Creates transport bookings and plant hire requests, reviews quotations, accepts or rejects offers, tracks active jobs and views booking history.

Broker

Reviews incoming requests, prepares quotations, coordinates with fleet owners and manages job assignments.

Fleet Owner

Maintains vehicles and drivers, receives assignments and manages fleet availability.

Driver

Receives assigned transport jobs, updates trip status and completes deliveries.

Administrator

Manages users, approvals, master data and overall platform operations.

4. Transport Booking Workflow

1. Customer creates a transport booking.
2. Booking is submitted to the broker for review.
3. Broker prepares and sends an official quotation.
4. Customer accepts or rejects the quotation.
5. After acceptance, payment is completed.
6. Fleet and driver are assigned.
7. Transport is completed and booking is closed.

5. Plant Hire Workflow

The Plant Hire module follows a quotation-based process similar to transport bookings.

1. Customer submits a plant hire request.
2. Request is forwarded to the broker.
3. Broker verifies the request and prepares a quotation.
4. Quotation appears in the customer's 'My Quotations' section.
5. Customer accepts or rejects the quotation.
6. After payment, the machine is assigned and dispatched.
7. Work is completed and the request is closed.

6. Main Modules

Customer Portal

Manage bookings, plant hire requests, quotations, tracking and booking history.

Broker Portal

Review requests, prepare quotations and coordinate assignments.

Fleet Management

Manage vehicles, drivers and transport resources.

Driver Portal

View assigned jobs and update trip status.

Admin Portal

Manage users, approvals, reports and platform settings.

7. Key Benefits

- Centralized management of logistics operations.
- Transparent quotation and approval process.
- Reduced manual workload.
- Improved communication between stakeholders.
- Better tracking and operational visibility.
- Scalable architecture for future business growth.

8. Future Enhancements

- Mobile application
- Real-time GPS tracking
- Online payment gateway integration
- Analytics and reporting dashboards
- Automated notifications
- AI-assisted route optimization

9. Conclusion

LoadAfrica provides a modern and integrated solution for logistics and plant hire management. By connecting all stakeholders through a single platform, the system improves efficiency, transparency and operational control while supporting future expansion and digital transformation.